



Health Communication and Patient Education (HCPE)

Module 5: Difficult Conversations

Bad News, Emotion and Conflict

Lesson Notes

KMVTECHUG

Version: 2026

Bad News

Prepare, assess knowledge, warning shot, chunks, emotion, plan.

Emotion

Silence, name feelings carefully, avoid false reassurance.

Conflict

Calm voice, acknowledge frustration, safety limits, call help.

Reflect: *What is your first line when a patient is angry about waiting?*

Closing

Next: consent, stigma, families.